

Pairing off

It is important for birds to find the right partner.



Peacock: the male shows off by shaking his spectacular tail.



Swans: when a male and female swan mate, they stay together for life.



Pheasant: male pheasants fight aggressively with each other for females.



Spotted-backed weaver

Building a home

The male weaver bird builds an incredible nest that hangs from a branch. When a female passes by, he hangs beneath it fluttering his golden wings and shrieking to her to join him.

Foot dance

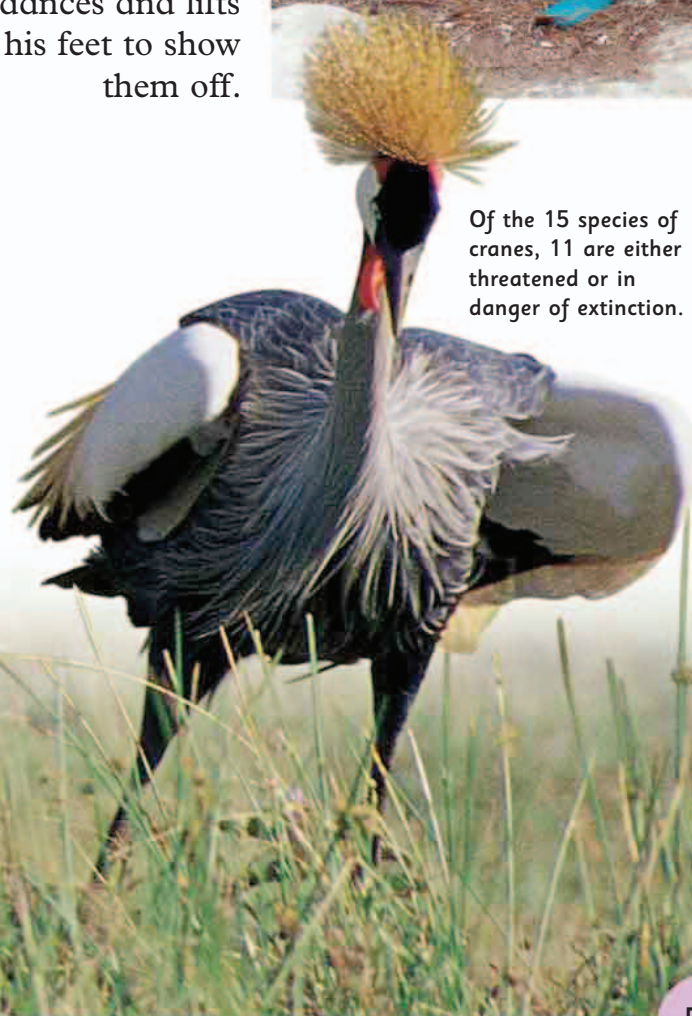
The blue-footed booby has blue feet, which attracts the females. When a male wants a mate, he dances and lifts his feet to show them off.



Once cranes have selected a partner they dance together, then bow, leap, bounce, and make sudden frantic runs.

Show off

The male frigate bird has a huge, red neck pouch, which he inflates with air when he is looking for a mate. When a female passes by, he wobbles it around and makes gobbling noises to impress her.



Of the 15 species of cranes, 11 are either threatened or in danger of extinction.